

## Western Digital Caviar SE16 WD7500AAKS

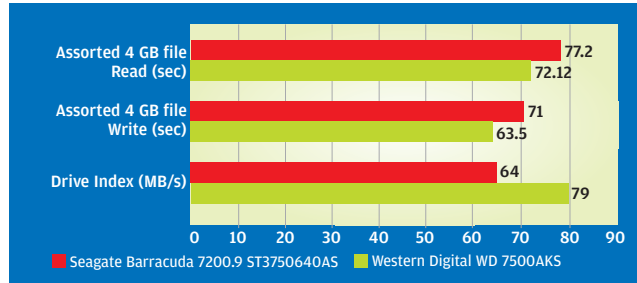
### Recommended!

The Caviar SE16 WD7500AAKS is the top-of-the-line high-capacity (750 GB) drive from WD. The drive uses a four-platter design with 16 MB of buffer, which is the norm in this segment. Like other Western Digital drives, the WD7500AAKS implements SecurePark and IntelliSeek for improved shock tolerance in powered-off mode and improved power

| RATINGS         |       |
|-----------------|-------|
| Performance     | ★★★★☆ |
| Build quality   | ★★★★☆ |
| Value for Money | ★★★★☆ |
| Overall         | ★★★★☆ |

management respectively.

The graph below is a comparison between this drive and the 750 GB Seagate Barracuda ST3750640AS we'd received for our internal hard drive test in June 2007. After this, and an assortment of other tests, neither drive emerges a clear winner.



The cost per GB comes to about Rs 15—good enough. The price of Rs 11,500 is a little high for those looking to update to a spacious secondary drive, though it's a decent purchase as a primary hard drive.



#### Specifications

750 GB; 7200 rpm; Buffer: 16 MB; Weight: 0.63 kg; Dimensions: 147 x 101.6 x 25.4 (W x D x H) mm; SATA 2

Contact: Venktron Digital Systems Pvt Ltd  
Phone: 09322672594  
E-mail: mahesh@venkatron.co.in  
Web site: www.wdc.com  
Price: Rs 11,500

## Spice D-88

### Double identity!

GSM and CDMA have their advantages and disadvantages—it's difficult to choose which way to go. The advantage of GSM is the wide range of mobiles available, and a lot of operators to choose from. CDMA's advantage is the incredibly lower tariff.

But now, Spice has launched the D-88—the first mobile phone in India to support both standards.

The sleek candy-bar D-88 has a black plastic body with a gloss finish. It is ruggedly-built, but an exception to this ruggedness is the flap covering the batteries: it is flimsy. The flat membrane keypad sports a metallic finish. The ordinary-looking hands-free features a volume control dial. Though sluggish, the phone interface is not bad, really.

The D-88 supports CDMA along with dual-band GSM. Accepting two SIMs, one from each network type, the phone can operate simultaneously on both networks.

Screen resolution is 128 x 160, lower than any stan-



dard phone in its price range, but we must say the image quality is rather good. Snaps taken with the 1.3MP camera are nothing to brag about, and video capture quality is no better. There is no flash. A hot-swappable 256 MB micro SD card is provided, and the

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phone supports up to 1 GB micro SD card capacity. MP3 playback is, at best, passable. There's no FM tuner.

The D-88 is not good at catching weaker GSM signals. The volume level of the speaker is rather low, even at maximum volume. We tried the hands-free, but the results were similar—not recommended in crowded places. The D-88 does not feature a speakerphone.

The Spice D-88 supports GPRS, and the accompanying USB cable gives you the convenience of connecting to

the wireless Internet from your PC or laptop. Surprisingly, the phone does not feature any standard options such as Bluetooth or IR. Java applications are not supported either.

Rs 9,849 seems a bit too much for the Spice D-88, but then it lets you live two lives at the same time... We do think it's too early to go for this phone; wait and watch for developments in the area of dual-network phones.

#### Specifications

GSM 900/1800 and CDMA 800; Weight: 93 gm; Dimensions: 106.85 x 47.15 x 14.82 mm; 262K TFT, 128 x 160; Camera: 1.3 MP with 10x digital zoom; Connectivity: USB, WAP 2.0, Class 10 GPRS; Video format: 3GP; Memory: 256 MB micro SD; Bundle: USB cable for charging and data transfer, electric charger, stereo hands-free; Stated talk time: up to 3 hours in GSM mode, up to 2.5 Hrs in CDMA mode; Stated standby time: dual-mode—up to 120 hrs, CDMA—up to 180 hrs, GSM—up to 200 hrs

Contact: Regional Distributor  
E-mail: trade-enquiry@spicemobile.in  
Web site: www.spicemobile.in  
Price: Rs 9,849